Nishal Stanislaus Silva, *PhD*

Applied AI/ML Scientist | Time-Series, Computer Vision, Optimization, Predictive Modeling | Applied ML

Canadian Permanent Resident, Eligible to work in Canada without sponsorship

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Re: Staff Applied AI/ML Scientist – lululemon

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Staff Applied AI/ML Scientist role on the Enterprise Data & AI team at lululemon. I am a machine learning scientist with a PhD (University of Trento, 2025) and 10+ years across industry and academia, and I build end-to-end ML systems that run in production. I want to apply that to a vertically integrated retail business, where model quality shows up directly in planning and operating decisions.

Three parts of your posting match my work. For production ML and optimization, I spent over five years at MAS Holdings leading ML and computer vision systems in manufacturing, including decision engines for output prediction, machine allocation and capacity planning on streaming IoT data across distributed sites. Care-label inspection alone cut inspection time by 99.5% and raised operational efficiency by up to 300%. For evaluation rigor, I design benchmark suites with baselines and ablations to guide model and architecture choices under compute constraints, and I released four open datasets on Zenodo. For real-time inference, my published system runs at 14 ms on a Raspberry Pi 4 with F1 0.76, 74x faster than the DTW baseline (Journal of the Audio Engineering Society, 2026), and I owned its lifecycle from data acquisition to deployment and monitoring. At MAS I also mentored engineers and set code review and CI/CD practice.

I should be direct about the gaps. I have not built demand forecasting, inventory or assortment models in a retail setting, and my industry time is about five and a half years plus a PhD and postdoc, rather than nine to twelve years of corporate research. My time-series, optimization and multi-component deployment experience is on manufacturing, sensor and audio data, and I expect to learn the retail domain quickly by working with your product and business partners. I have not set evaluation standards across a multi-team organization at your scale, but I have defined them for my own pipelines and would like to grow into that.

I am a Canadian permanent resident based in Toronto, eligible to work without sponsorship, open to relocating to Vancouver for the onsite arrangement, and available immediately. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can support the Enterprise Data & AI team at lululemon. My portfolio, publications and open datasets are available at nishal.xyz.

Sincerely,

Nishal Stanislaus Silva, PhD